conditions is Russia's full compliance with the sanctions program. It is not at all certain that the United States will agree to grant Russia full recognition as an equal power, and it is doubtful whether Russia will settle for less.

D. An American attack did not appear to be a realistic option during President Obama's term, for three reasons. First, it would be an admission of the failure of the president's engagement strategy. This strategy embodied the vision that Obama brought with him to the White House—that he would be the president who would bring about reconciliation between the United States and the Muslim world. Also, the United States was embroiled in two major wars—in Iraq and Afghanistan—whose end and extent of continued American involvement are still difficult to foresee. Finally, there was a domestic economic crisis.

E. An American attack in the Trump era would appear particularly problematic at this point in time (in late 2018, about a year and a half after Trump's entering the White House):

1. On the Iranian nuclear issue, as with all of the major issues Obama dealt with, Trump adopted the contrary position. From his first day as president, he voiced his stance against the nuclear deal with Iran, which had been signed by the world's powers (and Germany) in addition to the United States.
2. On various occasions in the first half of 2017, Trump stated his thoughts, ideas, and even threats regarding pulling out of the agreement and imposing new sanctions on Iran. He also hinted that in October 2017 he would not sign a document confirming that Iran was complying with the requirements of the agreement, contrary to statements by the military and security echelons of the United States and the European body in charge of oversight. In response, Iran's foreign minister announced that if Trump carried out his threat, Iran would consider announcing its withdrawal from the agreement and would renew and possibly even accelerate its nuclear development program.
3. The withdrawal of the United States from the agreement was a slap in the face to Great Britain, France, Germany, Russia, and China, who had invested two years of negotiations with Iran before the agreement was signed.
4. The United States' withdrawal from the agreement set a precedent that may cause great difficulties in finding a solution to the crisis with North Korea.
5. It is impossible to know at this point in time (2018), even after the Trump-Kim summit, whether and how the crisis between the United States and North Korea will be resolved. As to Iran, the first round of the resumption of sanctions is already in place, to be followed by harsher sanctions toward the end of 2018. Discussions in Washington are whether US strategy should aim for a change of regime in Iran or just denuclearization.